



Malta



0 5 km
0 5 miles
(approximate scale)

Painted boats

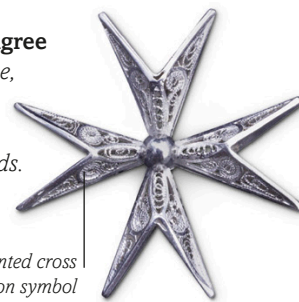
Colorful Maltese fishing boats called luzzus can be seen in the popular fishing village of Marsaxlokk.



- 122 sq miles (316 sq km)
- 457,300
- Valletta
- Maltese, English

The islands of **Malta**, **Gozo**, and **Kemmuna**, together with **smaller islets**, form the country of Malta. Over the course of its history, this **archipelago** has attracted **foreign powers** such as the **Phoenicians**, **Romans**, and **British**.

Maltese filigree
In the ancient art of filigree, artisans weave delicate jewelry from fine gold and silver threads.



The eight-pointed cross is a common symbol in Maltese filigree.

Blue Lagoon

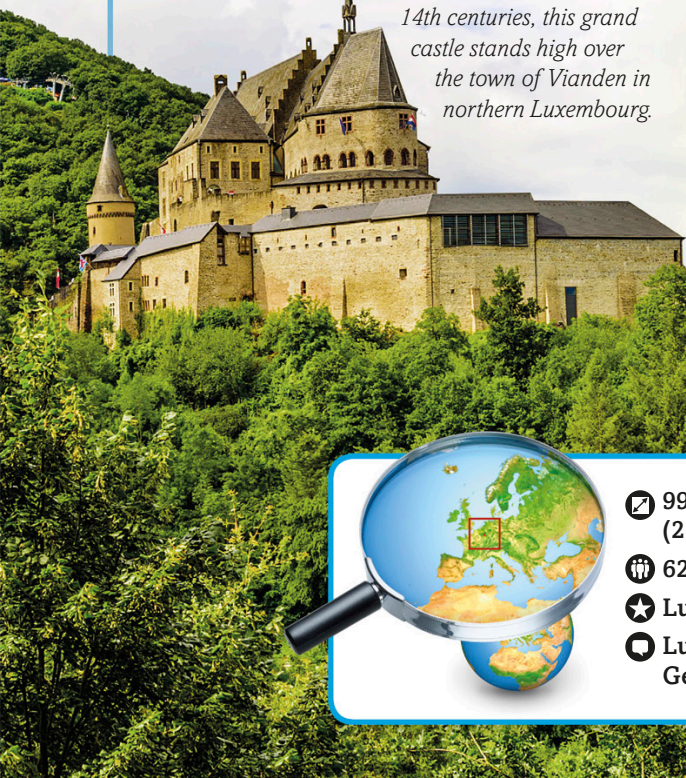
Between Kemmuna and Kemmunett islet is a bay with clear, turquoise waters that is popular with swimmers and snorkelers.



Luxembourg

Fortress on a rock

Built between the 11th and 14th centuries, this grand castle stands high over the town of Vianden in northern Luxembourg.



Moules marinière

Despite being landlocked, mussels cooked in a white wine sauce is a popular dish in Luxembourg.



Bird whistles

Every Easter Monday, bird-shaped whistles are sold for the celebration of Emaischen.

The handcrafted ceramic whistles are called péckvillercher.



- 998 sq miles (2,586 sq km)
- 628,400
- Luxembourg
- Luxembourgish, German, French

Landlocked Luxembourg is **one of the tiniest countries in Europe** but also among the world's richest nations. **Banking** and **insurance** and a growing **internet businesses** make it very wealthy.